



'Resident Evil' TV Series

Netflix has begun developing a scripted series based on the Resident Evil franchise backed by Constantin Film. <https://digit.in/feb19-63>



Amazon releases 'The Boys' Teaser

Amazon releases the first trailer for its adaptation of Garth Ennis and Darick Robertson's comic book 'The Boys'. <https://digit.in/feb19-64>

Are we living in a Blade Runner future?

Drawing a comparison of the depicted technological advancements with the current times.

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he thing about dystopia is one wouldn't even realise if they're already living in one. It

doesn't have to necessarily be a world where everything has gone wrong. All it takes is a single aspect of our society or nature taking a terribly unexpected trajectory from an ideal or moralistic standard. Ridley Scott's Blade Runner was based on a sci-fi book 'Do Androids Dream of Electric Sheep?' By Phillip K. Dick. It imagined a dystopian future where climate change has taken its toll on Earth with heavy industrialisation visible across the landscapes and no flora or fauna in sight. This impending doom probably jumpstarted a fierce space race that resulted in humans reaching distant stars and colonising extraterrestrial planets. Of course, not all planets are going to be habitable. So, humans artificially developed human-like androids called Replicants to take the burden off from humans to do our dirty work. We literally created artificial lifelike slaves.

It's clearly a dystopia. However, not everything in this future is terrible. Several technological innovations have been depicted in the movie that take place in the year 2019 in Los Angeles. Things such as flying cars, digital

billboards, video calling booths and much more were predicted back in 1982 when it was made. In this article, we'll be exploring all those predictions and whether we are currently living in a Blade Runner world. From this point onwards, we will be assuming that you've already watched the movie. If you haven't, we would highly recommend you to patiently watch this sci-fi classic and then come back to this article to truly enjoy it.

REPLICANTS

Central to the story of the Blade Runner universe, replicants are genetically engineered androids resembling human beings to the finest details. Replicants are as close as it gets to humans since



they are completely made up of organic materials. A regular person won't be able to tell the difference and only Blade Runners like Deckard can identify them after putting them through the Voight-Kampff test. Their sole purpose is to be used as a labour force on harsh offworld colonies where it isn't safe for normal human beings to work or explore. Since there's full control over their development, they can be given different abilities such as superhuman strength, high intelligence, etc. Are we capable of building such artificial beings? Not at all. We have only managed to reach a stage of building mechanical bots capable of carrying out normal and heavy duty tasks. Physically they do resemble humans to a great extent.

However, the moment they start moving or physically interacting or even speaking, it's a dead giveaway. Humanoids or robots that look like humans are present in plenty. Jia Jia is one such example that closely resembles a Chinese woman. Then there's Sophia which is another robot displaying the capabilities of artificial intelligence by interacting like a human would, using speech. Development in AI, as seen on IBM's Watson, advances in genetics and robotics are important to make the convergence happen. In its current state, it's pretty easy to know the difference between a robot and a human. The abilities or features needed to match that of replicants is far off.

FLYING CARS

There was always this romanticism with flying cars in the portrayal of sci-fi right since the time we invented airplanes. Right from the Jetsons to Back to the Future, the presence of flying cars in the future was something people imagined to be a natural progression. In Blade Runner, flying cars are common and the cops are seen using them (called Spinners) frequently. Are we there yet? Well, almost. Flying car concepts have existed since a really long time (probably since the invention of the airplane) and it looks like we are finally going to see them as early as 2020. Recently, Boeing conducted their first test flight with their prototype built with Aurora Flight Sciences. AFS is also working

